historical record.

Both Policy as Code and Policy as Data offer unique advantages. As organizations adopt zero-trust security models, deploy AI agents, use decentralized credentials, and are required to employ real-time risk assessment, these unique advantages will become even more important. By separating concerns with different dynamic authorization methodologies, organizations can scale authorization decisions efficiently without sacrificing flexibility or security.

1.5 The business case for dynamic authorization

Many leaders see access management as primarily a means of protecting and securing computer systems—important, but of secondary importance to the organization. But since computer systems have come to intermediate almost every interaction the organization has with employees, contractors, partners, and customers, they should also consider dynamic authorization a strategic business enabler. Investing in a robust, flexible, and pervasive authorization infrastructure can drive revenue growth, operational efficiency, regulatory compliance, and competitive differentiation.

1.5.1 Reducing operational costs

As we've discussed, manually managing access using rigid, static authorization models like ACLs and groups is labor-intensive and prone to errors. Organizations that rely on static methods often have employees who are dedicated to managing permissions for employees and others. These employees also perform manual audits, track down problems, and manage groups. As the organization grows, these processes become more complex, scaling superlinearly due to interactions in the system, as shown in figure 1.4.